



18 SCAMS TO WATCH OUT FOR IN 2019

With millions of people and machines utilising the internet in their daily operations, a number of scams to swindle people out of their money and identities are emerging. As technology has evolved, some of these scams have become very advanced. However, some of the older, less sophisticated scams still hold the power to con people today.

01 **ADVANCED-FEE FRAUD**

This type of scam is known to have a wide number of variations and is seen most commonly executed through emails and text messages. You may get a message claiming that you have won a lottery, are the sole beneficiary of some estate money or land or even that you have an old, forgotten bank account. This is one of the oldest scams in the book, and people still keep falling for it. Once you have paid up, the scammers know you are an easy target, and extort even more money.

02 **WORK-AT-HOME JOB SCAM**

Working from the comfort of your very own home and getting paid for it seems like it may be too good to be true. Unfortunately, this is actually the case. Scam artists attempt to capitalise on people's fantasies and attempt to lure them into work-at-home jobs. However, in order to begin the process, the person would have to send a wire transfer or money order upfront to pay for 'study materials' and 'equipment'. There is no job.

In a day-and-age when everyone is always connected, scams are an inevitable consequence. Here are 18 scams you need to look out for in 2019.

Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in

03 **CANCELLED NETFLIX ACCOUNT**

A sizeable number of Netflix users were hit with phishing emails from frauds that were attempting to obtain sensitive information like CVV and card expiry date. The messages came from an authentic-looking Netflix official email clone which claimed that the target's payment failed and their account would be cancelled if the target did not update their CVV and card expiry date into their phishing website.

04 **CEO SCAM**

This type of scam is mostly targeted at businesses. The scammer zeroes in on a person within a company who has access to the funds - preferably someone new in the finance department. The scammer then proceeds to call the target as the CEO of the company and tells him to send a sum of money urgently into the scammer's account. CEO phishing is considered to be one of the most effective phishing scams since it involves a sense of urgency and emotionalism.

05 **GRANDPARENT SCAM**

This scam involves someone calling a grandparent as their grandchild and asking for an amount of money urgently. They

may give excuses such as being in jail, needing medical health abroad, or more but the main premise is that they need money urgently. This often plays at the heartstrings of elders. However, a grandparent not knowing what their grandchild sounds like seems like the scam won't work, right? Wrong. According to a report, over 50 people have fallen for this scam.

06 **RANSOMWARE**

This is a type of malware which involves the scammer encrypting all the files in your system and promising to decrypt them only in exchange for a fee. The simple way to avoid this kind of scam is regularly backing up all your data. One of the most prominent examples of ransomware was the WannaCry Attack in 2017. More than 4,00,000 machines were affected in this scam and the criminals obtained an estimated \$1,40,000 worth of bitcoin to decrypt all the machines.

07 **SEXTORTION**

This kind of scam is notoriously common now since we have websites and social media like KIK messenger, Live.me, Yik Yak and more. Victims of sextortion are usually lured by manipulative strangers into sharing intimate photographs or vid-